



hangir Art Gallery from 1963, has shaped many an artistic career. The late Kekoo Gandhy, who first entered the world of art through his Chemould Frames business, soon transcended from the prosaic to the profound, giving the 'Progressives' of his time a platform to showcase their work and find buyers. Kekoo and his wife Khorshed were the undisputed kingmakers of the city's art court. Their daughter Shireen, second-generation gallerist, who assumed directorship in 1988 along with her father, took it forward, to its current location and position. And her daughter Atyaan Jungalwala partnered with Sunaina Kewalramani in 2022, to create the Chemould CoLab, yet another space created to nurture and set free young artistic talent.

The granddaughter we spoke of, whose love for art was kindled early, returns to the multigenerational Gandhys' gallery as it is today, to write this piece on Chemould Prescott Road, Mumbai, celebrating six decades of its illustrious existence. The two-part exhibition titled *CheMoulding | Framing Future Archives* is curated by art historian Shaleen Wadhwana. *Framing* (September 16 to October 28) is the result of more than 30 Chemould contemporaries such as Kallat, Shilpa Gupta, Anju Dodiya, Varunika Saraf and Nilima Sheikh responding to curatorial prompts directed at the works of veteran artists like Tyeb Mehta, K.H. Ara, Bhupen Khakhar, Rummana Hussain, Jangarh Singh Shyam, etc., to create works in multiple mediums, thus bringing to life the journey of Chemould.

Shireen Gandhy explains, "Chemould's selection of artists has never really been about 'art for art's sake'. Each has responded to the sociopolitical events of the times." Wadhwana, who has conducted in-depth archival research, says, "You would enjoy the archival timeline we have built. We get into this exact history of the nation told through the lens of art at Chemould."

Gallery Chemould, at the forefront of the country's art scene since its inception on the cusp of India's Independence, has shaped many an artistic career

September 14 to November 4 will also see *Continuum* at the Chemould CoLab, Mumbai, where young artists have allowed their creativity to be ignited by that of Chemould's big names. And then, from October 30 to November 5, the gallery team is curating a show titled *Remembering* at the original first-floor location in Jehangir Art Gallery, which will have artwork that was showcased or sold there at some point, along with stories that bring alive those times. The last chapter of this celebration will be *Futuring*, on from November 14 to December 23, which will further emphasise the gallery's genius for staying true and remaining relevant. ■

Priya Pathiyan



↑ **TREASURED PAST** Works by Jatindra Kumar Sen





being held at Arthshila, Syambati, Santiniketan, till October 19. It is curated by sculptor K.S. Radhakrishnan. Niyogi Books has published an eponymous book that documents the exhibition's genesis. Radhakrishnan says, being from Kerala, he was not familiar with Jatin Sen's drawings. However, the spooks caught his eye and he decided to organise an exhibition of the original drawings, when well-known collector, octogenarian Parimal Ray, showed them to him. Ray had discovered this cache of Sen's original drawings and Basu's manuscripts in 2013-14 at what was once the writer's former home at Bakulbagan in Kolkata's Bhowanipore area. The house was later occupied by Dipankar Basu, Rajshekhar's great-grandson, who let Ray search for the original manuscript. Basu often made the primary sketches and Sen followed them. This is the first time the drawings are being exhibited along with captions in English and a summary of the relevant story.

Sen was born in Chandannagar but raised in Darbhanga, where his father worked for the maharaja. He was good at drawing and was trained at the Government Art School. He was a pioneering commercial artist and did many illustrations and logos. A great raconteur himself, Sen designed the logo of the film studio New Theatres and the first cover of *Desh* magazine. He helped draw the Bengali typefaces for Linotype machines. However, it was his collaboration with Parashuram that will keep Sen alive in our minds. ■

Soumitra Das